



SECRETS TO personal branding + resume building **JOB HUNTING**

includes free cheat-sheets
and bonus tutorial

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INTRODUCTION

personal branding + resume building

What is a personal brand?

Your brand is how you present yourself in the eyes of other people. It is the make-up of your unique persona. It contributes to how others perceive who you are, what you bring to the table.

In the words of Jeff Bezos; *"Your brand is what people say about you when you are not in the room"*.

Done correctly, and personal branding can help you in the building of larger social networks; be it for business or just personal development. This may include getting clients, partners, job offerings by companies.

Why is your personal brand important, though?

Personal branding is not just about gaining a large number of followers on Instagram or Facebook.

Although it does involve social media, the term personal branding goes beyond this and encompasses even how well written your resume is, all the way up to the way you talk and walk into an interview.

One of the outcomes of successfully building a personal brand for yourself is usually acquiring qualifications and skills.

This e-Book aims at equipping young graduates and individuals, with a lack of experience, with the knowledge to create expertise in their chosen field, attain job-related skills, and introduce themselves as professionally as possible, when it comes to finding a job.

What is in this ebook?

Firstly, we begin by establishing the basis for your brand. This means that you are going to take a deep dive into your core characteristics, strengths; as well as take a closer look at your shortcomings. In the end, you will end up with more awareness of what you could excel at.

What is a personal brand?

In the first section of this e-Book, you are going to find downloadable cheat-sheets to get you off for a good start; calendars to keep you organized and on track. Be mindful that this is going to require lots of effort, time, patience.

Then, as we lay down the foundations of your brand, we bring attention to some of the downsides that social media has on people; but especially young ones.

Next up, we walk you through crafting your resume in a way that lack of work-experience is only second to polishing and showing off your actual experiences and skills; what you have done so far, and the qualifications you have earned!

What's the relationship between building a personal brand and writing a resume? If you recall the renown series; How i met your mother, season 7 episode 2 [yes I love this series] Marshal's dream of becoming an environmental lawyer almost falls through, because when he gets a call from his dream company, his internet record [a.k.a personal brand] depicted him as a drunk nut-head who had run naked in his college campus.

So, to put it briefly, the answer is that a personal brand can have a positive or negative impact on your resume application negatively when recruiters look you up. They feed on each other. Good brand, bad resume = low chances at getting the job. **Bad brand, good resume = still slow. And good brand, good resume = strong candidate!**

This said, and without further ado, let's get started, shall we.



START YOUR BRAND In THREE simple steps

+ free printable cheat-sheets

Start your brand, build your basis

This is your northern-star. As you start developing your brand, you should know what you stand for.

This way you can always monitor and put your brand in check when you face adversity, or feel lost in the woods. Here is a list you could use to get started. Then build your brand on top of your values. For instance...

1. Philosophical, deep, thoughtful
2. Witty, playful, playing jokes all the time
3. Very methodical, have a plan for almost everything, love organization
4. Mellow, sweet, smooth talker, cultured

One of the most prominent examples of successful self-branding is the story of Mark Manson.

Mark Manson is an author, blogger, and entrepreneur. Mark built his whole persona on being straight-up and direct... His most successful book (which made the NY Times bestselling list) is called *The Subtle Art of Not Giving a F*ck*, and he uses the unedited edition of that title whenever he discusses it online.

Mark keeps a consistent brand image. His fans could probably recognize his writing even if he didn't use a byline. His posts are long, in-depth, irreverent, and above all inherently honest. So, his main value is honesty and he has successfully turned it into his calling card and built a whole career just out of being himself.

Okay, you may be thinking now; how is anyone going to take me seriously if I am kidding around, and being deep about life all the time? This is not it. Now you put these into the SWOT analysis sheet.

SWOT stands for; strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats for your brand idea. But a SWOT analysis is extremely helpful because it lets you see the bigger picture.

Looking at yourself from this point of view will help you set out for capitalizing on your current core characteristics, while at the same time, improving on your weaknesses.

Start your brand, build your basis

Carrying this out can have a positive impact on your self-esteem as well. But most importantly, as you take stock of what makes you *you*, you - again - can adjust the way your brand will be in the future.

Bring on those things people love about you; strengths, and improve on those which they do not; your weaknesses. Alright? Since you signed up for this e-Book, you are going to be getting from us more on this via e-mail. But let's continue.

True, there are celebrities and people on the internet who have made a career out of being outrageous. You may even follow some of them - I do. Why not? We should listen to diverting and differing points of view.

However, if you decide to imitate someone's reckless behavior, it can influence your image and a whole career negatively. Every single action of yours is important and one wrong step can cost you a job!

The same situation happened to Desmond Hague. He was videotaped kicking a little puppy. Even after apologies, promised 1,000 hours of community service, and a huge donation, the public wasn't satisfied.

Eventually, this situation led to the resignation of Hague as CEO of the top food concessionaire Centerplate.

This is not to say, go ahead and be a people-pleaser; but rather become aware of how you can be better, how everyone around you can become better; which goes into the slot of opportunities in your SWOT analysis sheet - ;).

Essentially, you are also taking steps towards becoming a better version of yourself - But above all, you want your brand to be known for good things.

Download the file with the work-sheet yourself, and take the following as an example. Say, your brand is going to be about learning coding languages.

S

W

O

T

STRENGTHS

Learning coding languages are one my biggest passions.

I understand the basics already.

I got friends who are doing this, so they can guide me.

WEAKNESSES

This is a lengthy process to do.

I am not patient at all.

It is actually very difficult to learn coding languages

OPPORTUNITIES

If I start a page sharing content about learning coding languages,

I will sure see results.

Because this is a popular topic,

And I will also be learning myself while I am at it.

Also I can show my passion to future employers about coding languages, and build myself out as an expert on the topic,

which increases my chances at landing a job as a developer.

THREATS

I may never see the kind of success I want for my brand.

Due to the already existing competition out there.

I may give up after all, and get frustrated with it.

Skill up, but take your time

As you have taken a deeper dive into your core values, and opportunities to establish your brand as a positive force, now you must take steps towards improving on what you excel at; your skills - this will, later on, help you much to tackle your resume in a way that lack of a large employment history does not matter as much. ;)

Use the downloadable cheat-sheet sent alongside this e-Book pdf file, and take your time to fill it up. Plan out how you are going to begin tackling these skills accordingly.

You may choose to improve on some of them, but also start up a side-project which would be of relevance to your career.

A side project is something of relevance to your industry, which you can take up on your own. For instance, if you are interested in a job in web development, you could build a website for one of your relative's businesses.

As it turns out, you will keep coming back to your SWOT and calendar sheets, as you will likely continue thinking about it in the back of your head - we as humans tend to unconsciously continue our thought processes behind scenes even without noticing.

But so, every time you look at these cheat-sheets, be sure to jot it down, as something new will pop up in your mind.

But guys, you may be saying right now, I do not know where to begin with - *emoji crying*. If you do not know what to take on, spend some time looking at job descriptions that you would be interested in applying for.

Point is, if you are not doing an internship, or volunteering at all, do something that will help you prove you have some qualifications for the job you want. So whatever it is you decide to do, make sure it is relevant for the future.

Or else, take a look at experts in your niche or field which you admire and do what they do.

Skill up, but take your time

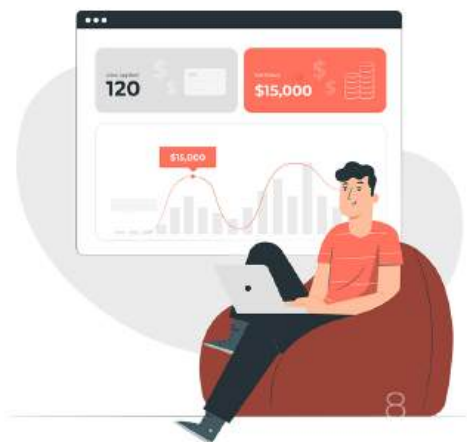
But in any case, you may do your research on MeetFrank, Indeed, GlassDoors, Europe Language Jobs. Whatever job portal you prefer. Just take a closer look at the skillsets they are seeking. And start skilling up!

For instance, some job descriptions tell you right at the beginning what they are looking for; so if you are interested in a graduate research position, and it reads that applicants need interview skills, excellent writing, and design skills, you should think about starting your blog, pour over it with all your language capabilities, and even start a podcast. Interview people there!

The calendar should help you plan out your strategy for going about this. But start easy. **Take on relatively small skill-sets, and projects, as they will yield the most results the fastest.** Since, they are smaller, they take the least amount of time and effort to carry out.

Take on greater projects and skillsets as you go. Earning the exact amount of experience and skill can take you months, even a whole year. So stay consistent. It took me a whole year before I was able to do more or less decent carousel posts in photoshop - lol.

Keep this in mind, since you do not want to overwhelm yourself and get frustrated. Go ahead and print out the cheat-sheets and hang them up in your room. But keep reading - haha. In the next page, there is an illustration of the calendar.



Goal:

Find out what to learn first, and break "it" down to small chunks.

Month:

October

Deadline:

End of October

MON

TUES

WED

THUR

FRI

SAT

SUN

Spend 2 hours researching what to do first when learning a coding language	Begin doing "A"	Spend 30 more minutes doing "A"	Spend 30 more minutes doing "A"	Spend 30 more minutes doing "A"	Chi	Chi
Move on to the next thing, do "B"	Continue	You get the point already				
						Review your plan, adjust, keep working

A general rule of thumb is to always keep your goal as specific as possible. You would rather look at it and say, yes I can do that; instead of; "oh, that looks like a lot of work". So keep it to a minimum, and be very specific.

Also, it needs to be something that makes you excited. Some people do get the goosebumps from the idea of learning a coding language. Nowadays, it seems like it is indeed a desirable skill. This means that many people are interested in it, so there is a lot of content to be produced.

Also make sure that it is something aligned with your goals. Video-editing does not apply to every endeavour or career. Perhaps you may be better off choosing public speaking, in which case you should aim for recording yourself and talking more often in front of other people.

Take to your socials

Marketing your stuff to an audience; *your audience*, is half of the battle. They put in half the work in the building of any successful personal brand. You may have a great idea, and the skills to make it happen. But it is pointless if nobody even cares about it.

This is to say; use social media to talk to your chosen audience, your industry. You do not want to find out later down the road that all you have done so far was for nothing; that the skills you have been learning and projects you have been taking on, are not even being noticed, and rather ignored.

People and industries are always evolving. Whether people are interested in your industry, and recruiters stop to look at your work, makes up 50% of your success. So make no mistake and promote your brand.

In other words, start a blog, Facebook page, etc... You must write and create content that people will want to read, and so become aware of your brand. They are all involved in the making of your dreams.

And if you are trying to get a job as a graduate researcher, you must write stuff people in academia care about, and tell them about it. through your social media. Promote your stuff.



Take to your socials

Hopefully, this all is making sense; having a two-ways communication channel with a clear target audience, and making them aware of what you are doing; what skills you are mastering, results in you looking more like an expert - in the making - in your field.

Look at it this way; anyone who is an absolute boss in what they do, at some point started right where you are. If you pitch your content, your brand in a clear and concise manner, you are already way more employable than when you did none of this.

Plus, when you begin doing this, chances are when you are at a networking event, or happen to meet someone with some influence in your industry, you have got yourself something to show them already!

I can not tell you how many times I have regretted not uploading my music, and missed out on a chance at growing my reach as an artist, by not having something compelling and neat to show with.

Would it not be awesome to be able to tell how you got this project in the making, and that you are actively working towards mastering such skills which you hope to proudly show off under your belt?

This would send a clear message to the receiver; this person is on it. People won't connect with you if they have no idea what you are about, or what you are doing.

Conclusion

To conclude with what encompasses the making of your brand, I would like to wind up with this.

There in the mainstream is the belief that you had better *not* tell nobody what you are planning. They say; surprise them with the results.

I believe that you should talk about it. Talk about your goal openly and freely. Whatever you are planning, which ignites a flame inside you, let it out.

Not only are you committing yourself to keeping your word, but also showing that you rejoice with burning passion, which hopefully other people will feed on, and gravitate towards.

Why am I saying this? Are you going for what makes YOU happy? Only doing what you like can help you to connect with people, and successfully build your brand, and build a career.

Avoid taking up activities that you are not strongly passionate about since most of the time you will end up dropping out of it - or miserable.



Conclusion

This does not mean to completely wave things your family or close friends ask of you. Being altruistic, and selfless is as rewarding as it gets. In fact, the great and one Nelson Mandela once said:

"What counts in life is not the mere fact that we have lived. It is what difference we have made to the lives of others that will determine the significance of the life we lead".

Do not be selfish; that is to say. But be true to yourself. In other words, embrace yourself. People can see right through fake, ungenue endeavors, and demeanors. Nobody even likes people who are sloppy and unserious about their business.

As you have decided to go in for what fulfills you the most, whatever you have to offer will become more self-fulfilling for others, as your passion shines with it. And they will also perceive you as helpful, and positive.

This guide is meant to reap real-world, practical results. This is why you need to talk to others about what you are doing, where you are trying to move in life; your goals. People cannot help or connect if they are not aware of it. Don't forget about choosing the people you talk to wisely; a.k.a, target audience because the wrong target audience also won't be able to assist you.

In the same way, choose your social circle rationally, since you want to be around the right crowd, which is also ambitious and passionate about advancing in life. Talking to people like this will help you to shape good values for branding yourself and become a better person in general.

Granted there will be plenty who will try to tear you down; so-called "haters". But there always is someone who dislikes you for whatever reason, nevertheless. So stay on your feet and try to create positivity with all this.

Conclusion

It does not mean you should be eye-folded and do not listen to criticism. But beware there are some which do not serve up any good for you either.

To sum it up though, defining your values, improving your skills, and promoting your brand to your target audience will mean nothing unless you're able to communicate with people, get their attention, support, and respect.



Downsides to Branding

**What you should keep
in mind**

What to keep in mind

As we said in the beginning, we are going to go over some of the downsides to starting your brand; especially for young people, because we are a generation that is all the more depressed, and anxious. And as it turns out, social media plays a crucial role in exacerbating these mental issues.

When you start your brand, you are taking the risk that the supercomputer on the other side of your screen will get to you.

Our intricate drive for wanting status, and power, seems increasingly dangerous for our mental health; when you decide to go in for it, make sure you know that your psychology is being played against you there, too.

It is an open secret that Facebook, Instagram, Pinterest can have a negative impact on people's sense of self-worth the longer they linger with their face down their phone.

Thus, as you develop your brand, know that you are going to be drawn into craving social-proof, fighting off strangers in comment wars about a difference of opinions, and so on.

At best, your self-esteem is going to take a toll. So you want to think about this before you set out on it.

Social media can play for, not against you though. But it depends, and it should not be underscored that most of the time, we are outplayed by an algorithm that gets smarter by the day. The same algorithm whose interest is not the collective good but in profit.

Try to make social media a tool that will serve up positive life changes in you. That is what we want for you anyways!

Just be mindful of the polarization it brings on people, and the effects it can have on yourself [now please subscribe and like our... I am kidding!].

Downsides to personal branding

The site, thesocialdilemma.com was created to educate and transform our society's quite sharp and very present lack of will to agree on almost anything. The main goal of this site is to tell people about such issues as privacy on the Internet, the effect of social media on our health, digital rights, social media manipulation, etc. We will be sharing content with you via e-mail about keeping a healthy state of mind, as well.

One thing has become clearer though. We rather bottle ourselves up with those who agree with us and tell us we are right. And at the same time, we suffer from the lack of attention and approval of strangers.

And to top this off, data is collected from us by these social media giants, which is then used to keep us looking down on our phones for longer, which then makes them a lot more money from advertisers who want to show up there.

Advertising does not have to be invasive, it can be ethical. Social media too. It does not need to be a rabbit-hole which does anything at hand to keep you sucked in. But where do we set those boundaries? And who draws the line? Easy or tough to say?

Whatever happens, it is worth having this conversation and training our minds to stay in a healthy state. And we would like this for you.



Compliment yourself

Now, this is an advice that will be decisive for when you are playing the game, and are starting, or already ascending to the top with your brand. You are going to get "hate". Whatever you do, I assure you there are going to be people who just dislike you - for any reason.

And on top of this, most of the time we criticize ourselves harder than we even criticize the rest. Wouldn't you agree? So if you go hard on yourself already, imagine what it will be like to handle spiteful, hateful comments from thirds over the internet?

Develop a thick skin; my friends. Know who you are, which was the very first thing we started within this ebook! And be aware of what you bring to the table.

Take time to ponder the last good deed or accomplishment you felt so deeply proud of, and learn to let that feeling expand in you.

Won't you agree we need to have a respectable amount of self-esteem for ourselves before others do? Have you ever woken up one day, feeling amazing, and receiving lots of positivity from around you and throughout the day?

Probably the answer is yes.

In large measure, that is because you were feeling alright yourself from the get-go. Whereas if you had had a bad day, in the end, you would wind up attracting that same kind of energy.

Spend more time reflecting on what positive accomplishments you have achieved so far. Whatever good deeds you have blessed your family, friends, the world with.

Think about it closely and carefully. I will bet you do have one or two good deeds that would make you proud daily. Write those down in some piece of paper. Hang it in your hall. And make sure they make you proud.

Compliment yourself

This way, whatever goes down later down the road, you can always think back on these, and look forward to a better day, nevertheless.

Now moving on, if you think that it is possible to use social media to improve your life, rather than stumble on it, read on in here. We believe it is possible, but with the right education about it.

Hopefully, you get to build employable skills with the aid of social media here and there, especially if you lack a lot of relevant work experience.

Despite this uphill battle to attain equilibrium between a solid personal brand, and the deep dark webs of social media, I strongly believe that it does have the capacity to catapult your career ahead.

However, a personal brand is not enough to land a job in the market. And students or recent graduates often make the mistake of not writing their resume like they should; putting up first their experiences and skills!

Leave out of the equation any lack of work experience, which greatly handicaps your ability to get accepted.



BEST RESUME **FORMAT** with no experience

Best resume, Functional format

This format works best for students because you forget about employment history and focus more on actual experiences and skills. Do not drive yourself up the wall with what to write, and the right way to write it. Chill.

Students and graduates do rely more heavily on a theoretical, and educational basis to land a job than someone who has been out in the job market for a while already and has garnered experience.

But it is totally fine. So if you are in a similar situation, a functional resume can help you land a job without the 2-years minimum of experience. Usually, recruiters will even look past this, and think to themselves; "ah, close enough", if you do not yet have 2 years under your belt.

Other options are the classic reverse-chronological resume, where you list your employment history from earliest until latest, and so on. This is the usual way students organize their application.

The format we are going to show you here lets you put forth your set of job-related skills, which you started earning and improving on with the help of the cheat-sheets - just a reminder you guys, hehe.

So, if you have looked into what skill sets are most sought after in your industry, and you burnt through the months on ends, and your box-tool now matches those standards. Now you need to think about crafting them into your resume accurately.

Here at Efektas Group, we are always looking for individuals willing to go the extra mile, whose eyes ignite with fire and ambition.

Point being made, worry not about what to write in your work experience section. But rather, bring up and let your skills speak for themselves. This is why you should go in for a functional resume.

This is what a functional resume looks like.



LUCIANO RAMIREZ

Graduate Research Analyst

Summary

Polyglot from Chile, fluent in Portuguese, as well as Russian. Extremely passionate about, and involved in Latin America's development research. Able to come up with powerful ideas, and transform them into organized written thoughts and graphics. Eager to work with and learn from people from different backgrounds.

Experience and Skills

Content Writer

• While at Efektas Group, I wrote original and thought-out content for engaging social media posts, blogs, and e-books.

• While at Efektas Group, I came up with and researched topics for our users from across the globe which they collectively benefited from.

• While at Efektas Group, I analysed the performance of our content, and subsequently wrote with even more intention and lucidity.

Graphic Designer

• While at Efektas Group, I created the feel and aesthetics of all visual elements on the marketing side: e-Books, free goodies, carousel posts, email templates. Indeed, I designed this resume template.

• While at Efektas Group, I led from a creative visual angle, with creativity, skill and professionalism.

Project Manager

• While at Efektas Group, I led a team with empathy yet decisive leadership on the research and writing of an entire e-Book on personal branding, in less than a month, which our users ate up.

• While at Efektas Group, I paid as much attention to detail on the visuals and aesthetics of the project as well as the written part of it, so the book would be flawless.

Education

Bachelors of Liberal Arts in Social Sciences, Tallinn University, Tallinn

September 2017 - June 2020

Relevant Coursework

• Survey Creation: Carried out study based on a survey, and interviews to measure the integration of international students with local Estonian ones at Tallinn University.

• Thesis: Performed a quantitative data analysis of a within-case study of how a lack of economic diversification has affected negatively Chile's development and income gap. Grade: A.

Graduated with a GPA of 4.2 out of 5.0

Work Experience

PR and Marketing Director, Efektas Group, Kaunas

April 2020 — Present

• While at Efektas Group, I was director of PR and Marketing, and was part of the Graphic Design team.

Project manager assistant, e-Governance Academy, Tallinn

Oct 2019 — Jan 2020

• Utilized excellent communication and writing skills to develop topical and interesting stories and outreach initiatives.

• Worked closely with project managers and engineers to ensure project needs were fulfilled and budgets were honored.

• Wrote a successful and neat article on the engagement of European Erasmus students into the civil society of their host country.

Contacts

Luciano Ramirez

+999 999999

youremail@email.com

yourportfolio.com

Skills

Research and Writing

Team-orientation

Time Management

Critical Thinking

Visuals and Designs

Languages

Spanish

English

Portuguese

Russian

Estonian

French

Hobbies

Languages

Song-writing

References

Ms. Catlyn Kima

Administrator of Liberal Arts in

Social Sciences, Thesis supervisor

Tallinn, Estonia

+372 6199 590

catlyn.kima@tlu.ee

Paul Duke

ESL instructor and Tutor,

Research Supervisor

Vancouver, Canada

teacherpaul1965@gmail.com

Linas Staršelskis

Founder of Efektas Group,

Kaunas, Lithuania

+370 63622116

linas@efektasgroup.com

Best resume, Functional format

See how the entry for work experience down below the section of experience, skills and education also?

Now, we are going to break the structure of this resume format down upon further analysis. But before we do this, I need to make something clear.

Before applying, keywords

What most applicants fail at all too often, is not spending enough time reading the job description and about the company.

So first, failing to match the right keywords there in your resume and the job description is only very crucial to getting yourself to the next phase – the interview.

Candidates who use the same resume to apply to different jobs rarely succeed. Most recruiters, especially those at larger companies, use software to weed out candidates who do not match the criteria; which is based on the keywords in the job description, and which you use in your application.

So take your time to read up on the job offer. Download or write the description somewhere and write your resume with it by your side. Sometimes you can have multiple descriptions, and take the most crucial keywords and write your resume accordingly.

Go through it over and over if necessary, since matching your resume with the keywords in the description will double your chances that the recruiter will see you are a possible fit.

Super tip: put the job description on a sheet apart for you to look at while building up your resume. This is so that you compare instantly which keywords you need to match between the job description and your application.

Before applying, keywords

Secondly, and ultimately, get familiar with the company. You have read what they want from you. Now, do they have something of real importance for you, other than a salary?

As a young person, sometimes we just want to get hired, and start earning money already! But bear with me. You are applying to work with this company. You want to get hired by them. Should you not have a genuine interest in knowing further about the company, and their objectives, how will you know that you are not going to quit a few months down the road; when you find out you do not like this and that about the company or the job?

Save yourself the hustle of switching jobs. Now with this out of the way, we are going to do the analysis promised earlier.

Functional format

Contact

You fill in your contact information in your resume with your name, phone number, and email address URL. If you have a personal portfolio, website, or LinkedIn profile, include them there too. In the future, we will send you further information on building your LinkedIn profile to your email inbox, so keep an eye out for that.

Resume objective; summary

What a professional summary should convey, is what you have done so far in your professional life, and why you want the job opportunity you are applying for. It is the first impression you get to make on the recruiter, so you want to come across as valuable an asset as you can, despite a lack of work experience.

Functional format

So to illustrate this, we are going to use throughout a job offer of a graduate research analysis.

You take away some of the keywords in the job description;



Job description

At Global Water Intelligence (GWI) we have made a business out of providing the information that helps businesses solve the world's water problems. We publish market-leading magazines, databases, and reports on the international water industry, and now we would like to expand our coverage of the Latin American market.

We are looking for an inquisitive and enthusiastic graduate who is fluent in Portuguese and Spanish to join our Oxford-based office. The position involves researching and writing accurate, interesting and exclusive information on developments in Latin America's water and wastewater treatment market, which will feature in our newsletters, monthly magazine, project tracker, and GWI WaterData, our web-based premium market analysis service.

As a Research Analyst at GWI you will get to grips with new subject areas, ask intelligent questions, and investigate which data points we need in order to find answers. In return we can offer you the support of a friendly and committed Oxford-based team, opportunities for travel (when travel is allowed again), and the sense of satisfaction that comes with creating something yourself and being able to say, "I did that!"

Though we are currently working remotely during lockdown, we remain a close-knit group in which autonomy, creativity and new ideas are welcome. As part of our team, you will be encouraged to take the opportunity to grow and develop within the company.

And...

If you are a recent graduate that is fluent in Portuguese and Spanish, and you think you might be good at two or three of the following skills, we would like to hear from you.

- Interviewing people: If we are going to publish original content, we have to be good at drawing ideas and information out of people. That requires confident and intelligent staff who can network their way to talking to the right people and asking the right questions.
- Writing and analysis: Fewer people have time to read these days. It means that if you are going to write, you have to write well. That means being able to organise your thoughts and express them concisely and with lucidity. Don't be deterred if English is not your first language. We can edit for English.
- An eye for detail: our business depends on our ability to speak authoritatively, and we can't do that if our work is riddled with errors.
- Seeing the visual angle: people increasingly don't consume information as text: they take it in visually. Feeding this kind of consumer is a challenge. It requires staff who can synthesise complex issues into simple graphics.
- Collecting and managing data: we are the main source of data for the international water industry. With that responsibility comes a number of important skills: a nose for the information that will make a difference, and a doggedness in pursuit of it; a dexterity in squeezing spreadsheets until they tell a story; a deep commitment to accuracy; and, an instinctual feeling for the reality that data purports to represent.
- Managing projects: most of what we do is a team effort, but getting great people to work well together is a skill in itself. We need people who are organised empathetic communicators to bring it all together.
- Seeing the bigger picture: we want to grow our business, and that involves having people at the front line who can see the opportunity to do things better.

Functional format

So you should write your summary something along the lines of;

👤 Summary

Polyglot from Chile, fluent in Portuguese, Russian, amongst others. Extremely passionate about, and involved in research about Latin America's development. Able to come up with powerful ideas, and transform them into organized written thoughts and graphics. Eager to work with and learn from people from different cultural backgrounds.

Utilize at least 3-4 keywords there in your summary from the job description.

Experience and Skills

What do you write in your skills section? You create a section named experiences and skills, and you put your title there. Below you write your main and most relevant activities. Use keywords related to the job.

So, to keep on with the same example, for this section you do something similar to in the summary section. And taking away from the same job description, I can confidently write in my CV the following:

🔖 Experience and Skills

Content and Copy writer

- While at Efektas Group, I wrote original and thought-out content as well as copy for our email-listing in each and every e-mail campaigns and newsletter we sent.
- While at Efektas Group, I researched which topics our users from across the globe would be collectively most interested in which they almost always loved.
- While at Efektas Group, I analysed the performance of our content, and subsequently wrote with even more intention and clarity.

Designer

- While at Efektas Group, I created the feel and aesthetics of all visual elements on the marketing side; e-Books, free goodies, carousel posts, email templates. In fact, I designed this very resume template.
- While at Efektas Group, I led with the visual angle with creativity, skill and professionalism.

Project Manager

- While at Efektas Group, I led a team with empathy yet decisive leadership on the research and writing of an entire e-Book on personal branding, in less than a month, which our users ate up.
- While at Efektas Group, I paid as much attention to detail on visual angle of the project as well as the written part of it.

Functional format

You should spend most of your time crafting this section to perfection. When you do not have the advantage of a long record of work experience, you must make the most out of any volunteers, internship, side project you took on, and show off your job-related leadership skills and such.

Also, you cannot understate the importance of spending time in the keywords stated in the job description. If you are short of words, look up what skills employers seek out most of all. But be ready to explain to the recruiter during the interview *how you have shown these hard skills*.

To name just a few, there are problem-solving, leadership skills, creativity, team-work.

Pro tip: include some kind of metric; 110%, 35% - and action word; planned, worked.

Education

Students without much employment history must naturally make use of their education qualifications.

In the education section, you begin by listing your degree title and university name, from the earliest to the latest.

In the functional resume format, however, you should list off those useful courses you took in the autumn semester which shows an important relationship with the job offer you intend to land.

Go ahead and add any favorite or relevant course to the job position with the grade you earned; it should be a good one, not just so-so, or mediocre.

Include any related-courses you passed with excellence, which shows you were a top-of-your-class student. If you do not have a related degree to the job position, then that is fine also.

Functional format

On top of this, you may additionally include any exchange or study abroad program. Go ahead, however, do this only if you think your employer will most certainly be able to; make, save them money and time.

Avoid listing anything that they can not use to make or save money for themselves. Remember that employers want people who want to work for them!

If you think it is relevant for the job, include your Thesis/dissertation titles, or Key academic achievements Study abroad Extracurricular activities

It would look more or less like this:

Education

Bachelors of Liberal Arts in Social Sciences, Tallinn University, Tallinn

September 2017 - June 2020

Relevant Coursework

- Survey Creation: Carried out a study on the integration of international students with local ones, based on a survey I carried out in campus.
- Thesis: Gathered quantitative data and performed a within-case study of how a lack of economic diversification has affected negatively Chile's development and income gap. *Grade: A.*

Graduated with a GPA of 4.2 out of 5.0

Functional format

Work Experience

In your employment history or work experience section you list the same or any related internship experience. For instance, add a leadership position you have held, perhaps at a student organization. It goes even to whether you have done volunteer work. It all goes here.

You begin with your job title, name and location of the company or internship place, the length of your working there, and finally up to four check-points of your main accomplishments and duties there.

Nonetheless, you need not spend much time here, unless it was relevant an experience. If not, your focus is on the set of job-related skills you have, which you already wrote previously.

Should you feel the need to earn more qualifications, we will slide into your inbox with some of our webinars and internship offers. So you do not need to worry about this.

Others; hobbies, etc.

Again, only list things that you think your employer can make money from, or save them time. Keep this in mind. So ladies in bikini and flying tigers are out.

Avoid these mistakes

First of all, leave out any job positions you had which are not related to the position you are applying now; simply forget about your cashier or babysitting experience if you are applying to web-development, for instance.

Here is the right example of how many people get it wrong.

Avoid these mistakes



Experience

SINCE 2012 > **BABYSITTING** >

- > Keeping
- > helping homeworks, bath, play, ...

JULY 2015 > **ANIMATOR FOR CHILDREN**

- > Doing animations, big games, handmade activitate, sport with children

JULY 2018 > **WORKSHOP IN GERMANY**

- > Project co-director : create a Landart in a PowCamp from Poland (Zgorzelec)
- > Cultural exchange : Italy, France, Germany, Poland, Ukraine, England
- > Exhibit my little comic in the PowCamp from Poland (Zgorzelec) museum

SINCE 2018 > **JAPAN EXPO PARIS** > **ARTIST EXHIBITOR**

- > Sell my art, Art commissions, sell my merchandises
- > Help visitors

JANUARY 2019 – APRIL 2019 > **STUDIO 2HB** > **COMIC ARTIST'S ASSISTANT**

- > Help a Professional artist
- > Create background, colors, lineart...
- > Use some art softwares

Now you guys tell me [!] Now that you know about the functional format we explained you here, would you put your babysitting experience there in your resume now? See why the functional format is just awesome?

Moreover, and second of all, **save your resume in the right format**. Applications must be saved – always – as a **pdf or word file**.

And it follows this order: Yourname-Lastname-Jobtitle-Resume.pdf [or word]
Otherwise, your application can be swiftly rejected, and end up looking like a mess.

In the next page there is a screenshot of a good illustration of this.

Avoid these mistakes

WORK EXPERIENCE
STUDFEST IMPULSE October-November 2019 PR-coordinator. Worked with partners in Kyiv, Kharkiv, Dnipro and Odessa
FREELANCE, SELF-EMPLOYMENT 2018-2019 English/German lessons for children Creating and translating of articles
EDUCATION
CERTIFICATE WITH DISTINCTION/JUNE 2019 Specialized school with in-depth study of a foreign languages Average score – 11.3/12

Recruiters have little time to review your application; about 7 seconds. Plus they use software to match the keywords in your resume and the job position to weed out applicants. So, keep it relevant, but also tidy.

In the next page, there is another example of a messy, cluttered, untidy resume. Just so you know, by the way, it is not to make fun of no one, but to learn - lol.

Avoid these mistakes

Professional Experience

Rīga First Language School

English Language Teacher, Erasmus Intern

RĪGA, LATVIA
June, 2019 – August, 2019

- **Researching interesting topics**, preparing presentations accordingly and presenting them to the children (preparing and printing out visual materials- handouts).
- Organizing (art, food) workshops to introduce and promote the cultures of different countries.
- Encouraging students to speak English and improve their speaking skills by **administering conversations regarding various topics**.
- Conducting grammar lessons and **preparing respective activities** to ensure fun learning experience.
- Brainstorming and **developing various creative activities** for the children to keep them engaged and active.
- Working together with other teachers to prepare new school year's curriculum (lesson plans, topics, materials etc.).

Voida International

Head of Content Development Team

BAKU, AZERBAIDJAN
April, 2018 – September, 2018

- **Researching, sourcing, writing and editing** various text, video and audio contents as part of content services offered by the company such as news, saving tips, horoscope and so on.
- Translating **web contents** and official documents from Azerbaijani and Turkish into English.
- Preparing **Product Description Wikis** for the available content services and keeping them up to date.
- Conducting research to discover innovative content services and generating new ideas.
- Created **FAQ Portal for Call Center Team** which makes accessible relevant information related to the company services. Updating and managing the FAQ portal.
- Leading the Content Development Team, **giving training about newly developed products and content services** to the team members.
- Supervising the members of the team throughout the content production and development process.

Voida International

Call Center Representative

BAKU, AZERBAIDJAN
March, 2014 – September, 2015

- Answering daily calls, **identifying customers' needs**, clarifying problems, providing solutions and ensuring that customers feel supported and valued.
- Documenting all call information according to the standard operating procedures.
- **Voice recording and editing** for IVR (Interactive Voice Response) promotions of the available content services of the company for marketing purposes.
- Delivering daily office management tasks such as meeting visiting costumers, operating documental procedures.

Recruiters' worst nightmare, I think.

Third of all, avoid making it longer than 2 pages. One page is ideal, but if you absolutely must have another page, then go ahead. However, go beyond this and you have exceeded your length. I am not going to do a screenshot of this - sorry.

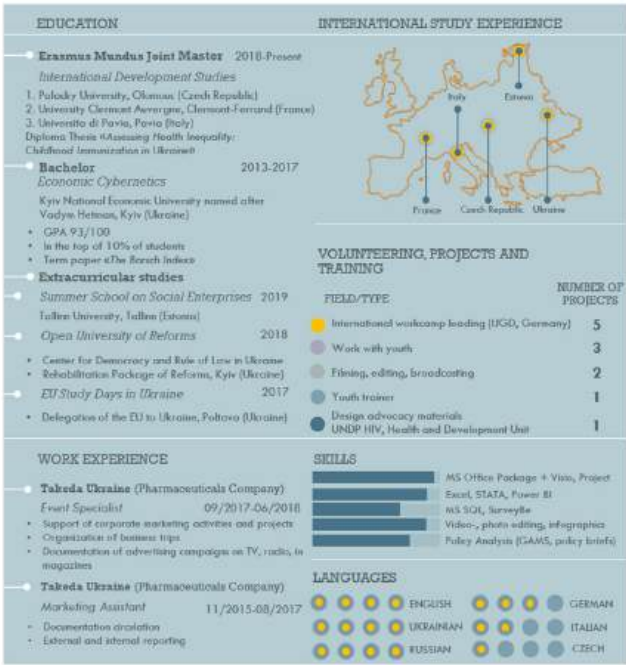
Also if you decide to link your personal Instagram or Facebook account, make sure they serve your purpose of applying for the position. If they do not contain educational, or entertaining posts about your industry, then avoid linking it to your resume.

However, I am hoping that will have worked on your personal brand so that you would link your social media in your resume, and that it will help you make a good impression on recruiters. Okay?

Avoid these mistakes

Fourth of all, you need to keep it simple. Being over-creative throws recruiters off with too many symbols and stuff which they will never spend time trying to understand.

Wild Screenshot :D



This last one also applies to the next point, which is fifth of all, guys, avoiding colorful templates. No need to show you any more screenshots, you get the point.

Lastly, avoid non-professional photos. There is an standar everybody follows. Nothing too much, nor hard to understand. Just a plain neat-looking photo where you look like a professional person; no fancy dress, crazy hair, colorful background. Dig?

Conclusion

Now, you may be wondering, where will you get a nice, neat, functional resume template for yourself now? Where to build yourself a functional format resume?

There is no shortage of free resources over there on the internet. You can build yourself your own resume using Canva, Word, or by typing "free resume template download".

However, if you would like to pay for a resume builder, that is also fine.

We can help you get started. Just send us the job offers you are interested in and a detailed sheet with your experiences, tasks and skills. Write to us at info@efektasgroup.com with a headline asking for more information or that you want to get your resume done with us.

With this all being said, you guys got a lot to work on. I will not say any further. But I am going to tel you this; **the worst you can do is just procrastinate. If you are passionate about something, pursue it. Just pursue it.**

This is best said by Joe Rogan; "the universe rewards calculated-risk and passion".

Thank you for reading. Hope you learned some usefull things. Write us if you have any question. And feel free to share this e-Book with a friend.

Warmly,

Luciano from Efektas Group.